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PARLIAMENTARY DEBATES

OFFICIAL REPORT

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Correction of errors of substance may be made only on the floor of the House with the permission of the Speaker. However, correction of typographical or grammatical errors which Members suggest for the Bound Volumes which will be compiled at the end of the Meeting may be clearly marked in the Daily Report, and the copy containing the corrections submitted at the Editor's Office, Parliament House, not later than four clear days after the publication of the Daily Report.

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THE
PARLIAMENT OF THE REPUBLIC
OF GHANA

THIRD MEETING, 2025

Friday, 31st October, 2025

*The House met at the Chamber,
Parliament House, at 2:47 p.m.*

[THE SPEAKER, RT HON ALBAN
SUMANA KINGSFORD BAGBIN, IN
THE CHAIR]

[PRAYERS]

The Speaker: Hon Members, we will move straight to the item numbered 5, *Correction of Votes and Proceedings* and the *Official Report*.

**VOTES AND PROCEEDINGS AND
THE OFFICIAL REPORT**

The Speaker: Hon Members, we would start with the *Votes and Proceedings* of Thursday, 30th October 2025.

Page 1...7—

Yes, Hon Frank Afriyie?

Mr Frank Afriyie: Mr Speaker, may I with your kind indulgence, draw attention to item numbered 5 on page 7, “Recognition of Schools”.

Mr Speaker, as we have it here, I think it is not reflective of the range of visitors we have had. If we take into cognisance

item (i), “Youth Parliament Consortium”, they are not necessarily schools, so I would rather that we replace schools with recognition of visitors. Thank you.

The Speaker: Hon Member, the item actually deals with schools and visitors. So, I may agree with you that limiting it to only schools may not be comprehensive enough to cover all the visiting guests to Parliament, so we can add visitors. The focus of this is actually on schools, because we want to catch them young and make sure that Parliaments and Hon Members of Parliament are felt at the personal level, the lowest level of our society.

So, we would add visitors to it to make it recognition of schools and visitors.

Page 8,9—

Yes, Hon Richard Acheampong?

Mr Richard Acheampong: Mr Speaker, thank you. Sorry for taking you back. On page 6, Hon Millicent Yeboah Amankwah was in the House, but she has been marked absent. Hon Eric Afful was also here. He wanted to correct it, but he could not catch your eye. He was also here yesterday but was marked absent on the same page. On page 7 also, Hon Queenstar Maame Pokuah Sawyerr was here yesterday and she is also marked absent. So, the Table can make the corrections for us.

The Speaker: The Table should kindly take note of that and do the necessary corrections.

2:57 p.m.

Page 8...12

Hon Members, in the absence of any further corrections, the *Votes and Proceedings* of the sixth Sitting dated Thursday, 30th October, 2025 as corrected, is adopted as the true record of proceedings.

I have two copies of the *Official Report*. The first is dated Thursday, 23rd October, 2025, and the second is dated Friday, 24th October, 2025. We would start with the *Official Report* dated Thursday, 23rd October, 2025.

Hon Members, any corrections?

Yes, Hon Member?

Mr Isaac Boamah-Nyarko: Mr Speaker, Hon Members, particularly, from my Side have not been served with copies of the *Official Reports*, and we do not also have it captured on the console for review.

The Speaker: Hon Members, when they are distributing Papers, they do not look at the Sides of the House. It is put in your pigeon holes. It is when that is not done and they have to share them here, then you would have the officials, who are these beautiful ladies walking between you and sometimes distracting your attention, distribute them physically here [*Laughter*]. Apart from that, Papers are put in your pigeon holes. Very soon, it will be a thing of the past. It will all be a paperless Parliament and you will be dealing with your system's technology

and that is where you would realise the importance of Hon Kojo Oppong Nkrumah.

Hon Members, with the Hon Member drawing my attention to the non-availability of copies of the *Official Report*, I will suspend our going through the correction of the contents to next week, Tuesday.

So, I accordingly defer the *Official Reports* of Thursday, 23rd October, 2025 and that of Friday, 24th October, 2025, to Tuesday for the necessary correction by the House.

With this, we move on to the next item numbered 6, Business Statement for the third week.

Yes, Chairman of the Business Committee?

BUSINESS OF THE HOUSE

Chairperson of the Business Committee/Majority Leader (Mr Mahama Ayariga): Mr Speaker, your Committee met yesterday, Thursday, 30th October, 2025 and arranged Business for the House for the third week ending Friday, 7th November, 2025 and a Report is hereby being submitted.

Arrangement of Business

Formal Communications by the Speaker

Mr Speaker, you may read any available communication to the House.

Questions

Mr Speaker, the Business Committee has scheduled the following Ministers to respond to Questions asked of them during the Week:

	<u>No. of Question(s)</u>
i. Minister for Fisheries and Aquaculture	7
ii. Minister for Roads and Highways	9
iii. Minister for Sports and Recreation	1
iv. Minister for Defence	4
v. Minister for Works, Housing and Water Resources	5
vi. Minister for Energy and Green Transition	10
Total Number of Questions	36

Mr Speaker, in all, six Ministers are expected to attend upon the House to respond to 36 Questions during the Week. The Questions are of the following types:

Urgent – 2; ii. Oral – 34

Statements

Mr Speaker, pursuant to Order 91(2), Ministers of State may be permitted to make Statements on Government policies. You may also admit Statements by Hon Members in accordance with Order 93.

Bills, Papers and Reports

Mr Speaker, in accordance with Order 159, Bills may be presented to the House

for First Reading. However, those of urgent nature may be taken through the various stages in a day in accordance with Order 160. Pursuant to Order 97, Papers may be laid during the week and reports from Committees may also be presented to the House for consideration.

Motions and Resolutions

Mr Speaker, Motions may be debated and their consequential Resolutions, if any, taken during the Week.

Referrals at Committees

Mr Speaker, the Business Committee has once again attached the list of pending referrals before the Committees for your attention and to remind the respective Committees to expedite work

on the referrals and report to the House. A total of Two Hundred and Ninety-Three (293) referrals to Twenty-Three (23) Committees for consideration and report to the House.

Mr Speaker, the Business Committee urges all Committees to prioritise consideration of the referrals and promptly report to the House in accordance with Order 267 (4).

Conclusion

Mr Speaker, in accordance with Order 216 (2) and subject to Order 67, the Committee submits to the House the order in which the Business of the House shall be taken during the Week.

Tuesday, 4th November, 2025

Roll Call

National Pledge

Statements

Ms Comfort Doyoe Cudjoe (Ada): To make a Statement on the Introduction of the HPV Vaccine in Ghana.

Mr Akwasi Gyamfi Onyina-Acheampong (Kwabre East): To make a Statement on the Challenges of the Cashew Industry in Ghana.

Questions

***345. Mr Duke William Allen Kwame Amoako-Atta Ofori-Atta (Fanteakwa South):** To ask the Minister for Fisheries and Aquaculture Development

the steps being taken to operationalise the One-Stop-Shop Aquaculture Licensing System in 2025, and how this reform will improve regulatory compliance and investment in the aquaculture industry.

***347. Mr Duke William Allen Kwame Amoako-Atta Ofori-Atta (Fanteakwa South):** To ask the Minister for Fisheries and Aquaculture Development when the proposed Blue-Economy Commission will be established and what legal or institutional framework will guide its operations

***354. Ms Shirley Kyei (Atwima Nwabiagya South):** To ask the Minister for Fisheries and Aquaculture Development when the Anomabo Fisheries College will be fully operationalised and what Academic Programmes will be introduced for the first cohort in the 2025/2026 academic year.

***355. Mr Elvis Osei Mensah Dapaah (Ahafo Ano South West):** To ask the Minister for Fisheries and Aquaculture Development the measures the Ministry has taken to ensure the timely completion of the outstanding components of the Anomabo Fisheries College infrastructure.

***358. Ms Gloria Owusu (Trobu):** To ask the Minister for Fisheries and Aquaculture Development the steps the Ministry has taken to intensify biosecurity protocols in aquaculture, including fish disease detection training, quality assurance and improved fish genetics.

***359. Ms Gloria Owusu (Trobu):** To ask the Minister for Fisheries and Aquaculture Development the support packages being offered under the Aqua / Cage–Culture Project to women and youth groups and how equitable access to these inputs will be ensured across Districts.

***360. Mr Rudolf Amoako-Gyampah (Upper Denkyira West):** To ask the Minister for Fisheries and Aquaculture Development the status of the 157 Premix Fuel Automation outlets under construction as of the end of 2024 and the steps the Ministry is taking to ensure the completion of the remaining 143 outlets in 2025.

Presentation of Papers

Motions

That this Honourable House adopts the Report of the Committee on Energy on the Petroleum Agreement among the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Energy and Green Transition), Ghana National Petroleum Corporation (GNPC), GNPC Exploration and Production Company Limited (Explorco) and Tristar Upstream Oil and Gas Limited (Tristar) for the exploration, development and production operations in the Ghana Western Basin Block 1 (GH_WB_01)

— (*Consequential Resolution*)

Committee sittings.

Wednesday, 5th November, 2025

Statements

Ms Dorcas Afo Toffey (Jomoro): To make a Statement on the Economic Empowerment and Financial Literacy of Women.

Mr Akwasi Konadu (Manhyia North): To make a Statement on the Rising Number of Deaths Due to Illegal Mining.

Questions

***299. Mr Bismark Tetteh Nyarko (Upper Manya Krobo):** To ask the Minister for Roads and Highways the status of the Asesewa-Abuorso road.

***356. Mr Maxwell Kwame Lukutor (South Tongu):** To ask the Minister for Roads and Highways when government will continue works on the Lotito-Hawui/Adidokpo road after construction of culverts since 2008.

***373. Mr Frank Asiedu Bekoe (Suhum):** To ask the Minister for Roads and Highways when the roads in the following communities will be completed: (i) Ntunkum (ii) Adarkwa (iii) Otwebediadua (iv) Gariba Zongo.

***375. Mr Michael Okyere Baafi (New Juaben South):** To ask the Minister for Roads and Highways the current status of the construction on the Manfe-Koforidua-Bunso Road.

***378. Mr Nelson Kofi Djabab (Krachi East):** To ask the Minister for

Roads and Highways the status of work on the Asukawkaw-Kanease-Dormabin road.

***415. Mr Kofi Amankwa-Manu (Atwima Kwanwoma):** To ask the Minister for Roads and Highways when the contractor working on the following roads in the Atwima Kwanwoma Constituency will return to site: (i) Ohwimase — Trabuom (ii) Ahenema Kokobeng — Anwiankwanta, (iii) Brofeyedru — Foase, (iv) Trabuom — Nweneso, (iv) Ampeyo — Asaago.

***386. Mr Kwame Appiah Kodua (Fanteakwa North):** To ask the Minister for Roads and Highways when the contractor on the Miaso-Ahomahomasu to Obooho road will return to site after halting construction some months ago.

***399. Mr Daniel Dung Mahama (Talensi):** To ask the Minister for Roads and Highways the plans of the Ministry to construct a new bridge across the White Volta, which links the North-East to the Upper East Region, considering the deplorable state of the current bridge and its impact on the proposed Pwalugu multipurpose dam.

***564. Prof. Hamza Adam (Kumbungu):** To ask the Minister for Roads and Highways when the contractor will complete work on the following feeder roads: (i) Kumbunu — Gupanargu — Kochim (ii) Kumbungu — Limo (iii) Kumbungu — Zugu — Yipelgu — Satani (iv) Zugu — Zugudabogni — Kushibo.

***351. Mr Dickson Kyere-Duah (Berekum East):** To ask the Minister for Sports and Recreation the current status of the Jinijini AstroTurf which was started after the 2024 elections but has been stalled since March 2025.

Presentation of Papers—

Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Department of Social Welfare for the year 2024.

Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Ghana Geological Survey Authority for the year 2024.

Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Forestry Commission for the year 2023.

Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Forestry Commission for the year 2024.

Motions

Committee sittings.

Thursday, 6th November, 2025

Statements

Ms Rita Naa Odoley Sowah (Dadekotopon): To make a Statement on honouring the Pan-African Vision and Revolutionary Journey of Yasmine Affoue Diawara.

Ms Laurette Korkor Asante (Atiwa West): To make a Statement on the Maternal Mortality in Ghana.

Urgent Questions

Mr Ralph Poku-Adusei (Bekwai): To ask the Minister for Works, Housing and Water Resources what strategies the Ministry is implementing to prevent Flood-Induced contamination of water resources in flood-prone areas like Chorkor and La Dade Kotopon, and how these measures will protect Public Health during rainy season.

Nana Asafo-Adjei Ayeh (Bosome Freho): To ask the Minister for Defence what measures the Ministry is taking to ensure the territorial integrity, security of Officers and Citizens of Ghana in the mist of the recent political instability in Togo.

Questions

***350. Prof Kingsley Nyarko (Kwadaso):** To ask the Minister for Defence how the Ministry plans to maintain professionalism in the Armed Forces of Ghana and enhance its capacity in protecting our territorial integrity and sustaining our democracy.

***490. Mr Thomas Worlanyo Tsekpo (Hohoe):** To ask the Minister for Defence whether the Ministry has plans to establish a terrorism training centre and forwarding operating base between Alavanyo and Nkonya as part of efforts to consolidate the lasting peace in the area and ensure security, development and productive use of the disputed land.

***578. Mr Kwadwo Damoah (Jaman South):** To ask the Minister for Defence what specific steps the Ministry

is taking to repair the presidential jet (Dassault Falcon 900EX EASY) which has been grounded in France since 11th March, 2025 due to serious corrosion problems.

***199. Dr Albert Tetteh Nyakotey (Yilo Krobo):** To ask the Minister for Works, Housing and Water Resources, the plans of the Ministry for the rebuilding of the Klo-Agogo and the Nkrakan Markets in Yilo Krobo.

***200. Dr Ebenezer Prince Arhin (Mfantseman):** To ask the Minister for Works, Housing and Water Resources when the water crisis in the Mfantseman Constituency will be resolved.

***270. Mr Bismark Tetteh Nyarko (Upper Manya Krobo):** To ask the Minister for Works, Housing and Water Resources the plans of the Ministry to complete the abandoned Bukunor Water Expansion Project which when completed will supply potable water for Bukunor Water Treatment facilities to Asesewa and other communities in the District.

***317. Dr Thomas Winsum Anabah (Garu):** To ask the Minister for Works, Housing and Water Resources the measures the Ministry is taking to provide the fast-developing Garu town with a town water system.

Presentation of Papers

Motions

Committee sittings.

Friday, 7th November, 2025

Statements

Mr Isaac Awuku Ayibor (Domeabra-Obom): To make a Statement on the Urgent Need for Insurance and Safety Regulations for Workers On High-Rise Construction Projects and Billboard Installations

Mr Tweneboa Kodua Fokuo (Manso Nkwanta): To Make a Statement on Dealing with Labour Unrests in Ghana.

Questions

***211. Prof Kingsley Nyarko (Kwadaso):** To ask the Minister for Energy and Green Transition the specific reforms the Ministry is undertaking to address the structured inefficiencies at the Electricity Company of Ghana (ECG), particularly in respect of high distribution and consumption losses.

***303. Prof Kingsley Nyarko (Kwadaso):** To ask the Minister for Energy and Green Transition the specific interventions the Ministry has taken to reduce the inefficiencies in the power distribution sub-sector of the Ministry.

***37. Dr Ohene Kwame Frimpong (Asante Akim North):** To ask the Minister for Energy and Green Transition the cause of the intermittent power outages and the low voltage experienced by the people of Asante Akim North.

***210. Mr Michael Kwasi Aidoo (Oforikrom):** To ask the Minister for Energy and Green Transition why the Government has not been able to meet the demand for power supply to households and industries.

***266. Mr Nana Osei-Adjei (New Juaben North):** To ask the Minister for Energy and Green Transition the steps the Ministry is implementing to extend electricity to the people of Asogya near Asikasu.

***300. Mr Maxwell Kwame Lukutor (South Tongu):** To ask the Minister for Energy and Green Transition the plans of the Ministry for the continuous removal of water weeds in the Volta River especially around the lower Volta Bridge at Sogakope.

***301. Mr Abdul-Fatawu Alhassan (Yendi):** To ask the Minister for Energy and Green Transition the current state of the ongoing rural electrification projects in the following communities: (i) Kpasani (ii) Warikpomo (iii) Pion Kamonaayili (iv) Zakolinyen Bologni Neinbong (v) Oseido (vi) Adoyili (vii) Klunkpanga.

***302. Mr Abdul-Fatawu Alhassan (Yendi):** To ask the Minister for Energy and Green Transition the state of the ongoing rural electrification projects in the following communities: (i) Baaduli (ii) Kpalsogni (iii) Nasal Achiriyili (iv) Jembogni (v) Bunbun Yapala

***305. Mr Abdul-Fatawu Alhassan (Yendi):** To ask the Minister for Energy and Green Transition the current state of

the rural electrification projects in the following communities: (i) Sunsongbun (ii) Kpatiya (iii) Nalogu Kpanji (iv) Banchiyili 1 & 2 (v) Kulkpeni (vi) Kpalsonado.

***306. Dr Thomas Winsum Anabah (Garu):** To ask the Minister for Energy and Green Transition the measures the Ministry is taking to resolve the rampant power fluctuation (low current) and frequent interruption of power supply to Garu and adjoining districts like Tempene and Nakpanduri.

Presentation of Papers

Motions

Committee sittings.

The Speaker: Any comments?

Yes, Hon Member?

Mr Peter Kwasi Nortsu-Kotoe: Mr Speaker, let me thank the Hon Majority Leader for the presentation. However, with the referrals, the records I have in my office shows that we have 22 referrals and not 82 as indicated in the attachment. I just want to draw the attention of the Hon Majority Leader.

The Speaker: That would be noted.

Yes, Hon Member?

Mr Frank Afriyie: Mr Speaker, with your kind permission, I would like to proceed by also thanking the Chairman of the Business Committee. However, I wish to bring to the attention of the

House an issue that has made so much rounds in the media the whole of the week, both traditional and social media, which has to do with absenteeism of respected Hon Members of this House.

Mr Speaker, I say this without any particular reference to any of the Sides. Indeed, the public is unaware as to who is a Member of the National Democratic Congress (NDC) or a Member of the New Patriotic Party (NPP). To most of them, Ghanaian Members of Parliament (MPs) are MPs.

Indeed, there is data equally making the rounds in the media as to the list of MPs who have repeatedly absented themselves from proceedings of the House, and this does not augur well with all of us. I want us to look at it in totality, and if Leadership on both Sides of the aisle will agree, I would like to appeal to the Chairman of the Business Committee that adequate provisions be made so that as MPs, when we meet at a Committee of the Whole, we could look at this issue very well.

Mr Speaker, the only silver lining over here has to do with the good news. I want to use the opportunity to congratulate you because equally in the media is the news that you have been appointed a member of a team that is supposed to negotiate peace between Russia and Ukraine.

Mr Speaker, this is another feat you have chalked at the global level, and indeed, your membership of the “Three-Wise-Men” in Ghana is yielding lots of dividends at the global stage. *[Laughter]*

3:07 p.m.

Mr Speaker, respectfully, before I resume my seat, I would like you to help us with regard to the time that we could commence proceedings in the House, just so we can guarantee that a reasonable number of Members of Parliament would be around for us to prosecute the Government Business. For some of us, we are religiously committed to our work, and we want to say that all would be well.

Mr Speaker, thank you.

The Speaker: The comment has ignited some interest, but I hope we do not dwell on the comment. That is not part of the Business that has been presented. He just made a proposal for us to have a Closed Sitting to discuss the matter.

Well, former Deputy Whip, who has returned.

Mr Matthew Nyindam: Mr Speaker, thank you very much for the opportunity. I went through the Business Statement, and I must say that when we started this Ninth Parliament, the Majority Leader made some good proposals, and it was going to facilitate and make things easier for Members. I bought into many of the ideas that he brought on board.

Mr Speaker, unfortunately, there are still a lot of things that we have not successfully implemented. I thought that the Majority Leader would have proposed in the Business Statement for us to have a Closed Sitting next week.

Unfortunately, going through it, I have not seen anything like that. I want to put it before you and to appeal to the Majority Leader, if it is possible for us to have a Closed Sitting next week to look at very important matters which cannot be discussed on the floor of the House.

That is the appeal I am bringing to you, Mr Speaker.

The Speaker: Yes, you are just emphasising the essence of the earlier comment.

Hon Member?

Mr Eric Afful: Thank you, Mr Speaker, for the opportunity.

Mr Speaker, on the absenteeism of Members of Parliament (MPs) from the House, I would appeal to the Table Office to intensify their checks on MPs who would be in Committee meetings; MPs who would be in Committee engagements outside the country; and MPs who would be in parliamentary delegations, so that they would not be marked absent simply because they are working for the nation.

Mr Speaker, it is part of the MP's work. I would therefore appeal to the Table Office to make sure that they intensify their work, not to mark MPs absent. Because, Mr Speaker, yesterday I was going home in the evening and I heard a radio station mention the roll call. So please, I would appeal to the Table Office to do the needful.

Thank you very much, Mr Speaker.

The Speaker: We spent some time on this matter and we explained it to all of you, including the staff, that if you are at such Committee meetings, a report should be submitted to the Table Office for them to capture it. The same for those delegations who are outside the country. Definitely, the Speaker would have to give permission. We give approval for them to go, unless it is on a private matter or you are going on a private business. So, all that should be communicated to the Table Office. We are taking all that into consideration.

But as I said, you should place premium on the Sittings and be physically present here. If it is a virtual Sitting, it would be so declared. We have had virtual Sittings before, that is where the world is moving towards anyway. So, we have taken note of all that and we will work on it.

The news circulating, I think, is from the records of the House. It is not something that has been officially released by the Speaker. But I think it is from the records that they are using. I do not know whether it is a corrected version of the *Votes and Proceedings*, because I do not have an idea about that.

But I did request the Table Office to compile a comprehensive report of the Sittings of the First Meeting and the Second Meeting. And that was done. Whether that is the record they are using or not, I have not cross-checked to make sure it is authentic. But definitely, it is a concern that the public is expressing and they are entitled so to do. It is just that we

have to look at our conduct and time management to present ourselves on the floor of the House during Plenary Sittings.

Please, that is the demand, and that is part of the mandate that has been given to you to represent them in their various constituencies. So, let us take it at heart, with all humility, and work on it. That is all that I can say.

The Speaker: Yes, Hon Member.

Mr Dominic Bingab Aduna Nitiwul: Mr Speaker, in due time, I would find out from you and demand your ruling on what constitutes attendance of the House, or attendance in the House; whether it is the Chamber or it is parliamentary work within the precincts of Parliament. But I would ask of you at a later date, not today. Even though various Speakers have given their ruling, I want you in particular to also give a ruling on this matter, because you have been a Member of Parliament for all these years. You have suffered it on both Sides.

Mr Speaker, I want to support my Hon Colleague, Mr Matthew Nyindam, that even if the Majority Side cannot bring the Minister for Finance, whom, if my information is correct and we all heard through newspapers and the media, that would be presenting his Budget Statement on 16th November, 2025—If it is correct, please bring him next week and let the House meet him.

The Speaker: I did not hear that. What did you say you heard?

Mr Nitiwul: Mr Speaker, I am saying that I read somewhere that the Minister for Finance would be presenting his Budget Statement on 16th November.

The Speaker: I am not aware of that.

Mr Nitiwul: Well, I read it somewhere that on 16th November —

The Speaker: The Minister for Finance is going to present his Budget Statement where?

Mr Nitiwul: Mr Speaker, maybe what I am saying is alien to you, but I am saying that I read it in the newspaper that the Minister for Finance would be presenting his Budget Statement on 16th November — [**An Hon Member:** It is a Sunday.] —It is a Sunday. [*Laughter*] Well, I am just saying that I read it somewhere. The Second Deputy Minority Whip is correcting me that they said 13th, which is a Thursday.

Mr Speaker, whatever the case is, I am saying that if the Minister for Finance is presenting his Budget over the next two weeks, please try and get him to come and meet the House. You know why I am saying that. We do not want what has been happening to repeat itself with him. Otherwise, it may repeat, and it may repeat in an ugly manner, which we do not want.

So please, the Majority Leadership should try and schedule him for next week and let us meet in the Committee of the Whole. Let us cross all the t's and dot all the i's, to make sure that Members are alright before he steps into this

House. It would help the Majority Side, it would help Members, and I am sure it would help the Speaker to control the House.

I am asking particularly for the Minister for Finance. Even if the Majority Leadership cannot schedule all the Ministers, they should find time to bring the Minister for Finance to this House before he comes to present the Budget Statement. They should bring him to this House at least one clear week before he comes to present the Budget Statement. Otherwise, three days to the reading of the Budget Statement, he would say he is busy and may disappoint.

Mr Speaker, thank you very much.

3:17 p.m.

The Speaker: Hon Members, you are Members of this House. You know that this House has been bestowed on Members in the House, Chaired by my good self, as an arm of Government. The other arms do not just walk into the House to transact business. They are allowed to make proposals. But we take the decision on when to host them.

And so, there is no such decision. If they are making proposals to individuals, it has not yet been made to me. His Excellency is the one who owns the Budget and it is presented for and on behalf of the President by the Minister for Finance.

I recall the Majority Leader dwelt on this matter here on the Floor. They have not communicated such proposal to me.

When they do so, and after all what you are referring to has been done, I will then convey to them that the House is ready and prepared to host them on this particular date. And that is the date that they will show up. They cannot appear here using any other means, because this is ours. They can appear here as strangers or as part of the members according to the Constitution. With that one, they can do so. But to come and present official Business, then it is on our invitation or our acceptance and that has not yet been done. So please, it may be speculation. It may be some personal contacts with the Minister, but not officially communicated to me for the benefit of the House.

So let us move on to the other items. Yes, Second Deputy Minority Whip?

Mr Jerry Ahmed Shaib: Mr Speaker, I am extremely grateful for this platform. Let me commend the Leader of Government Business for bringing us up to speed on issues of the Government.

Mr Speaker, since 24th or 25th August, I have not heard anything from that Side of the House or from the Government as to what is happening to our people in Gbinyiri in the Savannah Region with reference to the situation that occurred there which had to do with about 31 people dying, 48,000 people being displaced, and about 13,000 who have now become refugees in neighbouring Côte d'Ivoire. Respectfully, my request is to ask that either the Minister for Foreign Affairs or Minister for the Interior be programmed to respectfully come and furnish this House with some

information on what is pertaining to all of this.

The Speaker: I can see the Minister for Roads and Highways on his feet.

Yes?

Mr Kwame Governs Agbodza: Mr Speaker, my Colleague may be right about the unfortunate incident in the Savannah Region. But Mr Speaker, there is no evidence that Ghanaians have left the shores of Ghana and are refugees in another country—[*Uproar*].—Allow me. Mr Speaker, I rather know that currently, because of the situation in Côte d'Ivoire, some people in Côte d'Ivoire are rather coming to Ghana—[*Uproar*].—Beside me is Hon Buah. Mr Speaker, people from Côte d'Ivoire are coming into constituencies like that of Hon Buah. So, while it is all right to ask for a briefing on the current situation, to put it on record that Ghanaians are leaving the shores of Ghana in their numbers because of lack of safety in our country is neither here nor there.

The Speaker: Hon Members, let us allow this to end here. We have heard both of them. In fact, I thought the Minister was rising on a point of order, because the Second Deputy Minority Whip was still on his feet and making his contribution so I thought it was on a point of order. But maybe the way he phrased it is on a point of order in respect of misinformation or misleading. But definitely, there was evidence that some people left the shores of Ghana, crossed the river into Côte d'Ivoire. Now, efforts have been made for them to return and

all those were published but maybe the Minister's attention has not been drawn to that.

So, let us move on to other matters. Hon Members, it is just Business Statement. We have things to do.

Nana Asafo-Adjei Ayeh: Thank you, Mr Speaker. I want to commend your Committee, the Business Committee for programming the Business for the ensuing week. I have seen that they have done some good job. And I also acknowledge that my Question has been captured here. Mr Speaker, but I seek your guidance. During the opening remarks of the Majority Leader when the House resumed last week, in fact, his remarks had a full expression of him admitting to Government taking some steps towards getting the Minister to appear before the House to resolve or speak to the matter of the deportees.

Mr Speaker, last Friday, the Majority Leader again addressed the Business Statement and Hon Members raised very critical questions as to why the Minister for Foreign Affairs was not captured to appear to respond to the House. Yet again, this is the third week and the same Minister for Foreign Affairs has not been captured to appear before the House. My point is that there are some critical issues that when it takes time, the steam, discussion and the importance of the issue might as well be long past and gone before the Ministers make themselves available to appear before the House. So, I am asking if the House will give some prominence to some of the trending and particular issues and implore the

Ministers to appear before the House to address them. I do not know if it is allowed or there is a regulation to that effect. Thank you, Mr Speaker.

The Speaker: Hon Members, I will call on the Majority Leader to take note of the points that you have raised. But it is not for me to be drawing your attention to the tools that is available to you. If you are calling for a Closed Sitting or Committee of the Whole to discuss a pending matter, you have the opportunity to file an Urgent Question and the person will be hauled here to answer the Question. So, you do not have to keep on raising the same issue when you are not getting a response to your questions or your queries from the other Side. You ask Urgent Question.

Please, Majority Leader, kindly take note. If you have something to add, you can add. But I see your Colleague opposite is itching to say something.

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Thank you, Mr Speaker. I would like to find out from the Majority Leader and the Chairman of the Business Committee when we should be expecting the Minister for Finance on the 2026 Budget Statement. This is because other media houses have reported 13th November, even though the Speaker has indicated that is not known to Parliament.

Mr Speaker, I would also like to communicate through the Majority Leader to two of our Hon Ministers: Minister of State in Charge of Government Communications and Minister for the Interior, who showed

patriotism and togetherness in dealing with a matter I brought before them yesterday. Mr Speaker, we heard about the incident in Tanzania and one of us was an election observer there. There was a bit of chaos during their elections on the 29th October and there was no way we could contact the Member who was in Tanzania.

They cut off phones and internet in Tanzania. But I reached out to the Minister of State in Charge of Government Communications and the Minister for the Interior. They were very helpful and I just want to express my gratitude that they have shown patriotism and they should keep it up. When we are on the Floor and talking, it is different.

3:27 p.m.

But when we leave, we are together and we work for one nation, Ghana.

Mr Speaker, I do not know what the Hon Minister for Communication, Digital Technology and Innovations is trying to do. He is no longer a Backbencher; he is now a Cabinet Minister and by our Standing Orders, he is supposed to behave as such. So, he needs to stop all those things that he is doing. So, the Hon Majority Leader should note that. I also want to express my gratitude to the two Hon Ministers.

The Speaker: Yes, Hon Majority Leader?

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, the effort is being made to present a picture of non-attendance at Sittings of this House. But

every day, I look at the attendance and I see that the *Votes and Proceedings* have never, on any single day, reported that there was no quorum in this House, not even yesterday when the matter was extensively discussed. This morning, I looked at the *Votes and Proceedings* of yesterday and the report is that 199 Members were in attendance in this House.

Mr Speaker, these are the *Votes and Proceedings* I have gathered, and I have looked at each and every one of them, and consistently about 160 to 190, sometimes over 200 Members attend Sittings of the House. And so that attempt to present a narrative out there that Members do not attend Sittings in Parliament is totally inaccurate. So, I think we should go by our own *Votes and Proceedings* because that is an accurate recording of those who have been in attendance in this House.

Of course, at any given time, we need a certain number to do certain Businesses. When those times come up and anyone raises the issue of quorum, we have a mechanism for making sure that everybody gets into the Chamber so that we can have the relevant quorum to conduct such Businesses. Yesterday, when the issue of quorum was raised and the Rt Hon Speaker caused the bell to be rung, in 10 minutes, we got the number to form quorum. So, let us not, as Members of Parliament, join the narrative out there that we do not attend Sittings of Parliament; we do, but we have so many other things that we do as Members of Parliament.

Mr Speaker, you know that Committees are supposed to embark on benchmarking visits to other Parliaments. During the last three months, most Parliaments have been on recess the same way that we were on recess. So, if a Committee has a benchmarking visit to a particular Parliament which is on recess, how would the Committee be able to visit that Parliament? So, it turned out that many of the Committees shelved their benchmarking visits and immediately those Parliaments started sitting, the Committees rushed to fulfil those benchmarking visit obligations.

In addition, many Members on the Majority Side are members of boards and councils. Unfortunately, sometimes those boards and councils tend to have meetings at times that conflict with the time that we expect them to be sitting here for us to commence Business. But when there is an urgent need for them to come, we send a message on our platforms and everybody leaves whatever they are doing and rush in for us to constitute quorum to do Business.

Mr Speaker, I want to assure you that we will insist on getting our Members here on time. Some of them also sit in their offices, watching television and waiting for the Rt Hon Speaker to come into the Chamber before they come. I think that is a very bad habit. It is not respectful that we come to Parliament and sit in our offices. Yes, constituents will come and put pressure on us for our attention, but we must respect the Rt Hon Speaker and get to the Chamber before he comes in.

Mr Speaker, I wanted us to have the Committee of the Whole sitting yesterday, but the Minister for Finance has been out of the jurisdiction; he was in Paris with the President. So, we as Leaders decided to reschedule it to next week. When he is in town, we can get him to come and then we can discuss our housekeeping matters before the Budget Statement is presented.

The date for the presentation of the Budget Statement will be communicated to us through the Rt Hon Speaker. The communication will proceed from the Presidency. I know and I will be lying to you if I say I do not know. But the proper process is for it to be communicated to the Rt Hon Speaker and he will in turn communicate it to the rest of us when the Budget Statement will be presented. The Minister for Finance may make a public statement and give an indication, but that is just an indication. The actual date will be communicated to us through the Rt Hon Speaker.

Ministers will be scheduled when they are available to come and brief us on very important public matters. But the Rt Hon Speaker gave the indication that we can also use the various tools available to us to urgently summon ministers here to answer Urgent Questions, and in the process, we can address all the issues.

I believe those are the issues that have been raised and I want to thank all of you for giving me the opportunity. I have responded to the date the Budget Statement will be presented. I said the date will be communicated to us through the Rt Hon Speaker. I know, but there is

a process, and the process is that it will be communicated to the Rt Hon Speaker and he will communicate to the House. He has given indications that in due course he will communicate the date to us.

The Speaker: Hon Members, I think that should be sufficient. The issue of the attendance at Sittings is just our attempt in the Standing Orders to practicalise the provision of the Constitution. It is necessary for us to all go out there and do the advocacy to see how we can get our people along with us. So, it is not something we should split hairs about.

You are all aware of the norms of our society. Sometimes you are ready to rush to a programme, an elder arrives in your house and you dare not brush the elder aside and leave. It will mean a lot; you have to stay back to attend to them. There are a lot of these things we have to work on and it will take some time before we are able to manage our time well. But all the same, I insist that high premium should be placed on personal attendance. Unless it is a virtual Sitting, personal attendance to Plenary session is very important.

Hon Members, let me listen to Hon Member for Walewale.

Dr Abdul Kabiru Tiah Mahama: Thank you very much, Mr Speaker.

There was an issue from the previous Sitting which is still pending before this House, and that is the composition of Committees. There are some Committees of this House that are not fully

constituted. I will reckon that for the effective oversight of the House,

The Business Committee should also prioritise that, to ensure that all Committees are fully constituted. That issue has not been resolved and I can give examples of such Committees—

3:37 p.m.

The Speaker: Hon Member, which Committee is not duly constituted?

Dr Mahama: Mr Speaker, we have the Finance Committee, which was composed, but there were changes made. The changes have not been ratified by this House. It is one example of a Committee.

The Speaker: Changes made by who?

Dr Mahama: It was made by Leadership, and I can give an example, Hon Stephen Amoah—

The Speaker: Hon Members, please.

A House cannot take a resolution which will be amended by any person or group of persons; even the Speaker cannot amend that resolution. If you need to review, revise or amend the resolution, it has to be brought back to the House and by the Standing Orders, it is the House that can proceed to amend, revise or review the resolution. No Leader can do that.

But you used the word ‘constitute’. Then, in your answer, you talked about it being composed, and yet it has been

changed by Leadership. It is not possible. The Resolution that we took that day is still what is binding. And all Committees have been constituted and duly composed. I chair the Committee on Selection. So I do not know what you are talking about.

Yes, Deputy Minority Whip?

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, thank you.

The Hon Member has a point, and we are engaged to resolve it. It has not come to the attention of the Committee on Selection, which is ably chaired by you. There was some mix-up, and the Whips are engaging. We will have our meeting, and then relay to the Committee to ensure that if there are going to be any changes, we will do that by resolution on the Floor.

The Speaker: Yes, but Leaders, you cannot be doing that, because all you did was a nullity. It does not exist in the eyes of Parliament. They are just empty boasts. They have done nothing. So please, until it comes before the Committee on Selection, which I chair, and we present a report to the House, the Resolutions taken here cannot be changed by any person.

Please, Majority Chief Whip?

Mr Rockson-Nelson Etse Kwami Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, thank you.

One, the issue raised by the Hon Kabiru was in respect of the fact that at the time of passing the Resolution for the

adoption of the reports of the Committee on Selection, it was made that a couple of Members were not placed in a minimum of two Committees. So the direction was that we look at it and have that corrected.

Mr Speaker, so that has been outstanding, but my Colleague is on African Union (AU) observer duties in Tanzania, so as soon as he gets back, we will deal with that, and I will bring that to your attention, and then that can be resolved.

Mr Speaker, second, we have introduced advertising Statements admitted by you, so that Members will be aware when they will make those Statements on the Floor. So we just want to urge them that they should take notice, so that Members will no longer keep Statements and rush to the Chamber to make them. They should ensure that the statements are properly admitted and advertised; the dates will be given, so they are put on notice, so they can come prepared to make the Statements.

These are my few comments on the matter. Mr Speaker, I thank you.

The Speaker: Hon Members, the Business Statement as presented is adopted.

Let me acknowledge the presence of our visitors from various groups. We have four groups. The first group is from Kumasi Academy (KUMACA). They are 69 in number. It is located in the Asawase Constituency, and they are led by their teacher, Kofi Agyapong.

On behalf of the House, I want to warmly welcome you and to thank you for taking the time to come. At least you have had an experience of what happens on the floor of Parliament. We expect you to learn more, and in future, please do better than we are doing. You are welcome. You may resume your seats.

[Students of Kumasi Academy Senior High School were acknowledged]

We have another group coming from the Obuasi East Constituency, 75 in number, from the Presentation of Our Lady Catholic Girls School. They are led by their teacher, Christopher Boah. You are also warmly welcome. This is only a girls' school, and I actually do not see any boy there—*[Laughter]*

So, the same advice to you. Try and learn more so that you perform better in future. That is what progress and advancement are about. Kindly resume your seats.

[Pupils of Presentation of Our Lady Catholic Girls School were acknowledged]

We have another group coming from Assin Central. They are 61 in number, and they are from the Assin Atonsua M/A Anglican Basic. They are led by their teacher, Charles Aidoo. Basic school, which means they are younger.

You are warmly welcome. I hope you are watching your representatives and understand what they are saying. If not, it is a learning process. And do not

worry, in future you will do better than them. You are warmly welcome.

[Pupils of the Assin Atonsua M/A Anglican Basic School were acknowledged]

We have the last coming from Okaikwei South. That is Kaneshie North 3 Basic School. Led by the head teacher, Gifty Ama Serwa Hadzi. They are 79 in number. You are also warmly welcome, and the same advice goes to you. Our doors are always open, you can come even as individuals, and you will be given the opportunity to sit where you are, to watch what is happening. Please, pass on the message to your parents, so that they can advise your representatives as to what you want them to do. That is very important. They need the feedback.

You have heard them reacting to feedback on public discourse. It is very important to shape and direct the Parliament of Ghana. May you resume your seats.

[Pupils from Kaneshie North 3 Basic School were acknowledged]

Hon Members, as indicated earlier, we need to have a Statement presented today and we do not have much time, because today is the end of the month. I do not recall this House making a Statement on Breast Cancer Month. So there is a Statement pending, which I hope Leadership will make space for Members to comment on the breast cancer situation in our country.

Yes, Majority Leader.

3:47 p.m.

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, that is so, but I crave your indulgence to vary the Order of Business to allow the laying of some Papers so that we can then go back to Question time and then Statements.

Mr Speaker, the Minister for Lands and Natural Resources who is also acting for the Minister for the Environment, Science and Technology has the Environmental Protection (Mining in Forest Reserves) (Revocation) Instrument, 2025. If you would indulge us for him to just bow and lay that, and then also lay some audit report on behalf of the Ministers of Tourism, Culture and Creative Arts and Local Government, Chieftaincy and Religious Affairs. Later on, the Minister for Communication, Digital Technology and Innovations can also lay the Audit Report of the Ghana Publishing Company, then we can go back to Questions and Statement.

The Speaker: Hon Members, I proceed to vary the order of Business as requested by the Hon Majority Leader. Therefore, we would move on to the commencement of Public Business, Presentation of Papers, the item numbered 10. Minister for Environment, Science and Technology. That is what I have here.

PAPERS

By the Acting Minister for Environment, Science and Technology —

Environmental Protection (Mining in Forest Reserves) (Revocation) Instrument, 2025

Referred to the Committee on Subsidiary Legislation.

The Speaker: Yes, First Deputy Minority Whip?

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, sorry about that, but I am just rising under Order 97(3). Order 97(3) reads:

“A short explanatory statement shall be made by the person presenting a Paper when requested by the House or a Member upon the presentation.”

Mr Speaker, if we could get a little explanation in this revocation. He cannot just bow and go. Mr Speaker, when you said the Minister for Environment, Science and Technology, the Hon Majority Leader said he is acting. However, the *Order Paper* captured him as the Minister for Environment, Science and Technology and not the Acting Minister for Environment, Science and Technology.

The Speaker: Yes, Hon Majority Leader?

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, the person we have here was vetted and approved by the House as the Minister for Lands and Natural Resources. That is what this House knows we did. We vetted and approved him as Minister for Lands and Natural Resources. In the absence of a substantive Minister for Environment,

Science and Technology, the President has asked him to also act at the Minister for Environment, Science and Technology and communicated to the Rt Hon Speaker who in turn communicated to the House. So, he is acting as the Minister for Environment, Science and Technology; that is what he is for now. Whatever the *Order Paper* says, he is acting as the Minister for Environment Science and Technology. Therefore, I have not faulted in any way, Mr Speaker.

The Speaker: Yes, you have not faulted in any way. We are just waiting to hear a brief statement on what the Instrument is about. That is the request of the Hon First Deputy Minority Whip.

Mr Buah: Mr Speaker, you would recall the Environmental Protection (Mining in Forest Reserves) Regulations, 2022 (L.I. 2462) which was enacted in November, 2022 to ensure that environment management principles are legally enforce in mining operations in forest reserves. Public outcry led to an amendment of that Legislative Instrument (L.I.) by deleting Regulation 3(2) to effectively limit the President's power.

The new Environmental Protection (Environmental Assessment) Regulations, 2025 (L.I. 2504) entered into force on 2nd June, 2025. However, in light of current circumstances, it has become expedient to revoke L.I. 2501, and going forward, exploration or mining in forest reserves by legalised large-scale mining will be undertaken

using guideline reviewed in 2022 until a new L.I. is considered. I thank you.

The Speaker: Hon Members, we now go to the item numbered 9, Presentation of Papers and the following Papers to be presented: 9(a) by the Minister of State in charge of Government Communications.

Mr Ayariga — *rose* —

The Speaker: That is what I have on the *Order Paper*.

Mr Ayariga: Yes, Mr Speaker, and I earlier indicated that I wanted your permission for the Minister for Lands and Natural Resource to lay those on behalf of —

The Speaker: Granted. Yes?

By the Minister for Lands and Natural Resources (Mr Emmanuel Armah-Kofi Buah) on behalf of the Minister of State in charge of Government Communications —

Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Ghana Publishing Company Limited for the year 2024.

Referred to the Committee on Information and Communications.

By the Minister for Lands and Natural Resources (Mr Emmanuel Armah-Kofi Buah) on behalf of the Minister for Tourism, Culture and Creative Arts —

Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Ghana Museums and Monuments Board for the year 2024.

Referred to the Committee on Trade, Industry and Tourism.

By the Minister for Local Government, Chieftaincy and Religious Affairs —

Annual Risk-Based Internal Audit Workplan of the Zongo Development Fund for the year 2025.

Referred to the Committee on Local Government and Rural Development.

The Speaker: I think it is Local Government and Rural Development. We have not changed the name yet.

Any further variation?

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, I think we can go back to Questions and Statements.

The Speaker: Hon Members, we have a number of Questions— eight Questions, so I am going to restrict the number of supplementary questions and also the time that Hon Members use to lay foundations. We will start with the first Question. Question numbered 255 stands in the name of the Hon Member for Asokwa, Ms Patricia Appiagyei. Hon Member you may ask your Question.

Is the Hon Minister available? He may take the appropriate seat.

Yes, Ms Patricia Appiagyei, you may ask the Question now.

Mr Matthew Nyindam: Mr Speaker, I come under Order 88(3), and with your indulgence I read:

“In the absence of the Member, any other Member so authorised may, with the prior permission of the Speaker, ask the Question.”

Mr Speaker, I have her authorisation, but I need your permission to ask the Question on her behalf.

The Speaker: I did not hear you.

Mr Nyindam: I said I come under Order 88(3) —

The Speaker: Yes, I heard that one.

Mr Nyindam: I have her authorisation, but I need your permission as stated by the Standing Order to ask the Question.

The Speaker: Hon Member, granted. You may do so.

ORAL ANSWERS TO QUESTIONS

MINISTRY OF COMMUNICATION, DIGITAL TECHNOLOGY AND INNOVATIONS

Plans to Ensure Transparent and Equitable Management of Digital Innovation Fund

Mr Matthew Nyindam on behalf of Ms Patricia Appiagyei (NPP — Asokwa): Mr Speaker, I beg to ask the Minister for Communication, Digital Technology and Innovations the plans

implemented by the Ministry to ensure the proposed digital innovation fund, with an initial capital of US\$50 Million is transparently managed and equitably accessible to Ghanaian technology start-ups and youth-led businesses.

3:57 p.m.

Mr George: Mr Speaker, the Ministry is putting in place measures to ensure that the proposed Digital Innovation Fund, with an initial capital of US\$50 million, is transparently managed and equitably accessible to Ghanaian technology start-ups and youth-led enterprises.

The Fund will be established by the Ghana Innovation and Startup Bill (2025), which provides the legal framework for its management and governance. A Board will oversee the operations of the Fund to ensure transparency, accountability, and full compliance with public financial management laws.

The operations of the Fund will be guided by Acts 921 and 658, with annual audits conducted by the Auditor-General. Reports on the Fund's activities and performance will be submitted to the Minister and laid before Parliament for scrutiny.

Mr Speaker, the Ministry remains committed to ensuring transparency and fairness in the Fund's governance.

The Speaker: Yes, Hon Member, any supplementary question?

Mr Nyindam: Mr Speaker, as captured in the 2025 Budget, I would want to find out from the Hon Minister what is actually impeding his introduction of the Ghana Innovation and Startup Bill (2025), to Parliament since the lifespan of the Budget is almost ending.

Mr George: Mr Speaker, if my memory serves me right, there was no allocation made in the 2025 Budget for the US\$50 million Fund, so it is not a fund that has started being funded. Once the Ghana Innovation and Startup Bill (2025), which is the legislative framework that will guide the disbursement of the Fund, is laid before this House and passed, we will then activate in the subsequent Budget the US\$50 million Fund for its disbursement. But no allocations have been made. If we look at the ministerial allocations in the Budget for 2025, there was no line item for the Innovative and Startup Fund. Thank you.

Mr Nyindam: Mr Speaker, may I find out from the Hon Minister when he intends to introduce this Bill to fast track the activities and the allocation as well.

The Speaker: Yes, Hon Minister?

Mr George: Mr Speaker, the Ministry has completed its zero draft. We have invited input from the general public and have received same. We have proceeded to hold four stakeholder consultations: one in Tamale, Kumasi and Takoradi, and on the 22nd of this month, the last one was held in Accra. We have taken all those inputs, so we will complete that,

send it to the Office of the Attorney-General and Ministry of Justice, then Cabinet, and after that, meet with the Committee on Information and Communications and the Committee on Constitutional and Legal Affairs to then go through the processes.

We are hopeful that in the next Meeting of Parliament, we will be able to complete the processes and lay it before Plenary for consideration. Thank you, Mr Speaker.

The Speaker: Hon Members — yes?

Dr Mahama: Mr Speaker, I would like to find out from the Minister how Government is financing the initial amount of US\$50 million that is intended to be put into the Fund if so established. Is it through a budget, loan agreement or how does Government intend to raise the US\$50 million?

Mr George: Mr Speaker, the Minister for Finance will handle the source of funding once the Fund is set up.

The Speaker: Hon Members, we will move to the next Question. The Question numbered 418 stands in the name of the Hon Member for Keta, Mr Kwame Dzudzorli Gakpey. Hon Member, you may ask the Question. Yes, please?

Mr Frank Afriyie: Mr Speaker, with respect, I come under Order 88 (3) to seek your permission, and I have the authorisation of the Member concerned to ask the Question on his behalf.

The Speaker: You may go on.

Measures to Address Surge in Cyber Fraud Incidents

Mr Frank Afriyie on behalf of Mr Kwame Dzudzorli Gakpey (NDC — Keta): Thank you, Mr Speaker. I beg to ask the Minister for Communication, Digital Technology and Innovations what measures the Ministry is implementing to address the surge in cyber fraud incidents in the country.

Mr George: Mr Speaker, it is an undeniable fact that cyber-crime and cyberfraud issues are on the rise in recent times due to increasing sophisticated approaches used by cyber criminals and fraudsters leading to harm and loss of money to individuals and businesses alike. For instance, between January and September 2025 the CSA recorded 14,425 cases.

Measures Adopted in Curbing the Rise in Cyber Fraud in Ghana.

The Cyber Security Authority (CSA) adopted a multifaceted approach to dealing with the issues. These include strengthened collaboration with key stakeholders, intensified regulatory enforcement activities and intensified public education programmes.

Intensified Regulatory Enforcement Activities.

Mr Speaker, effective regulatory enforcement of cybersecurity issues requires effective collaboration with law enforcement agencies, both national and international.

The Authority closely collaborates with international partners such as International Criminal Police Organization (INTERPOL), the Federal Bureau of Investigation (FBI), the National Cybercrime Agency of the United Kingdom (UK), the African Forum of Computer Emergency Response Teams (AfricaCERT), and the Forum for Incident Response and Security Teams (FIRST). These engagements provide access to threat intelligence as well as cyber incident response measures.

For instance, the collaboration with the Criminal Investigation Department (CID) led to the arrest of 65 suspects including 49 foreign nationals involved in sophisticated online fraud schemes in June 2025.

A major coordinated crackdown on cybercrime in August 2025 led to the arrest of 39 individuals at Adom City Estate and Tema Community 25 in the Greater Accra Region. Further, in October 2025, following the support of the CSA, ten (10) individuals alleged to be involved in creating fake online food delivery platforms to defraud unsuspected customers were busted.

Strengthened Collaboration with Digital Platform Owners and other Social Media Stakeholders

The CSA currently maintains a direct relationship with Meta (owners of Facebook, Instagram, and WhatsApp) and ByteDance (owners of TikTok). The Authority is working to establish similar

relationships with the owners of X, Snapchat, and LinkedIn.

The CSA collaborated with social media platform owners and other digital service providers through the Computer Emergency Response Teams (CERTS) which led to the taking down of 203 website domains found to be involved in fraudulent activities. Additionally, 738 social media accounts used in impersonating Very Important People (VIPs) including Members of Parliament (MPs), government appointees and other high-profile people were identified and neutralised. A collaboration with Telecommunication Service Providers resulted in the blocking of 1,380 mobile numbers used for nefarious activities including online fraud.

Increased Awareness, Education and Publicity Activities on Cyber Issues

The CSA has since January, 2025 issued 11 public alerts and four technical alerts to inform and educate the public and institutions on trending cyber fraud incidents such as fraudulent investment and recruitment scams.

The Ministry, with funding support from the World Bank in July, 2025, launched the Safer Digital Ghana Campaign Initiative nationwide. Since then, a jingle was released to support the campaign, including the rollout of educational billboards at vantage points in all sixteen (16) administrative regions of Ghana. Both local and English languages were used to educate the public about cyber incidents including cyber fraud and mitigation.

4:07 p.m.

Again, regional fora, social media campaigns and various stakeholder engagements were adopted during the national celebration of the 2025 Annual Cyber Security Awareness Month in October. The year's celebration focused on four (4) pillars namely children, the public, businesses and the Government under the theme: "*Building a safe, Informed and Accountable Digital Space*". In addition, a national cybersecurity challenge was organised for Senior High School students across Ghana.

Mr Speaker, other awareness and publicity programmes implemented in 2025 include an engagement with 58,000 children and young people through the Child Online Protection sensitisation activities. Noting that the youth are enthusiastic users of digital technologies, the CSA engaged 5,657,398 individuals using digital platforms and radio engagements.

Mr Speaker, the Ministry is currently undergoing a review of the Cyber Security Act, 2020 (Act 1038). We are taking public memoranda. We have opened it up to the public and the draft is ready. We have received over 600 memoranda and that is going to be considered. We would hold our in-person stakeholder engagements. Hopefully, next year we would lay the amendments which will strengthen our capacity and ability to deal with cyber fraud in a responsible and responsive manner as the government.

Thank you.

The Speaker: Hon Members, we move on to the next Question and that is Question number—

Some Hon Members — *rose* —

Mr Speaker: Do you have any supplementary question? The two of you? You may go on.

Nana Asafo-Adjei Ayeh: Mr Speaker, thank you.

Mr Speaker, there has been quite a number of people, especially, those who are politically active, let me say some New Patriotic Party (NPP) activists, have been complaining about *meta* for restricting their accounts, posts and pulling down most of their activities without prior notice. What is also worrying is that, there are no remedies or avenues for reporting such activities. We agree that some of them may be fake accounts, but those who are genuine do not even have an avenue to complain.

Moving forward, would the Cyber Security Authority (CSA) of Ghana be used, particularly to clamp down or victimise political activists who want to express their opinion against government or against the ruling party?

Thank you.

The Speaker: Yes Minister.

Mr George: Mr Speaker, the CSA of Ghana under HE John Dramani Mahama has absolutely no interest in clamping down on dissenting voices or criticisms

of the government. We actually have no policy of clamping down or shutting down pages. In fact, the CSA of Ghana has no control over the platforms and does not have the ability to shut down pages on their own. All account shutdowns are done by the platform owners. So, if a post is taken down on *WhatsApp, Instagram or Facebook* by *Meta*, that is done by *Meta's* own community standards. It means that the content of that post breaches the community standards, that is not an activity of the CSA of Ghana.

Again, if a post is taken down on *TikTok*, that will be done by *ByteDance* and those platforms are not controlled by the CSA of Ghana.

I am grateful for the Question; it allows us to educate the public on the fact that, government is not responsible for taking down social media accounts and President Mahama's Government is extremely liberal and open to criticism, be it constructive or obstructive.

Thank you.

The Speaker: Yes, Hon Member?

Dr Abdul Kabiru Tiah Mahama:
Thank you very much, Mr Speaker.

Mr Speaker, I will first seek your guidance on this issue, because the Minister in answering the Question, added a certain matter which was not contained in the Answer given. I come under the combined effect of Standing Order 88 (4) and (5) for your direction on

whether the Minister in responding in a Written Answer, without being asked a supplementary question, has the right or the mandate to read an answer on the matter. Because, that forms the basis for the follow-up question that Hon Member raised and I also have a follow up question. But it is not a supplementary question that he was responding to so I would need your guidance on that before I ask my question.

Mr Speaker, thank you very much

The Speaker: Hon Members, submitted Written Answers are actually guides and so the ministers are by law and practice permitted to add on to or take away what they have submitted. So, you actually ask your supplementary question based on the Oral Answer, because these are referred to as Oral Answers and those are Oral Questions.

With the Written Answers, when you submit, they write it to you personally. But once it is oral, the Minister is permitted to come to the Floor and say something different from what is in the Answer. The only snag here is if it is substantive, he has to draw the attention of the House. But if it is a matter of additional information, editorial or some minor corrections, that is usually done verbally. That is my guide.

Yes, I am sure you had a supplementary question. You may proceed.

Dr Mahama: Thank you very much Mr Speaker for the guidance. I appreciate that.

Mr Speaker the Minister stated that they are maintaining direct relations with *Meta* and *ByteDance* and he only falls short of mentioning to us. If he says “direct relations” or “direct relations with them” it does not give the sense of this House. What does “direct relation” mean in the context of the Question that is being asked? The context of the Question is, how will that direct relationship prevent cybercrime or cyber fraud? I am just seeking clarity from the Minister when he said they are maintaining direct relation with *Meta* and *ByteDance*, what it entails.

Thank you very much.

The Speaker: Yes Minister.

Mr George: Thank you very much, Mr Speaker.

In responding to the previous supplementary question, I made the point that where there are accounts that flout the community rules of the platform, the platform owners are the only ones who have the power to take down those accounts. When an issue is raised, that flouts the community rules or flouts national rules and the CSA of Ghana needs to flag that, they need to do that with the platform owner. Under the cyber security framework, the convention on international cooperation under the Budapest Convention and then the Malabo Convention, we have what we call points of contact.

For Ghana, there are multiple agencies that operate in this space from the National Signals Bureau to Cyber

Security to Economic and Organised Crime Office (EOCO) and Financial Intelligence Centre (FIC) but the CSA of Ghana is Ghana’s focal point. All platforms also have focal points that we are able to speak with in real time.

So, take for example when the issue of a *Facebook* account was instigating direct violence against officers of the Ghana Armed Forces carrying out peace operations in Bawku. The CSA of Ghana through its direct point of contact on the platform drew the attention of the platform operator. When the unfortunate incident of August 6 happened, on *TikTok* there were a number of accounts that had posted videos of the burning wreckage.

Today, if you go online, you would not find any of those videos. Because we flagged all of those videos to the operator and drew the operator’s notice that they flout the operator’s own community guidelines that such content should not be allowed on their platform. This can only be done through the focal person and that is the kind of relationship we keep and establish for public protection.

Thank you.

4:17 p.m.

Dr Mahama: Thank you very much, Mr Speaker.

Is it all right to conclude that, even though the government is not responsible for taking down accounts of individuals, it can cause the service provider that is a social media company,

That is *ByteDance* and *Meta* to pull down an account of a person. Is it right to make such a conclusion?

The Speaker: Yes, Hon Minister?

Mr George: Mr Speaker, part of the mandate of the Cyber Security Authority is to ensure the protection of all of us. If we see any account that is posting content that is injurious and flouts the community standards, not of the Cyber Security Authority, but of the platform, what the Cyber Security Authority does is draw their attentions to it.

Mr Speaker, we have had instances where we have reported fake accounts in Mr Speaker's name to one of the platforms and they responded to us and said, per their own checks, that account did not meet the threshold of an impersonation account so they refused to take down the account. So, the fact that we make a complaint does not mean that the platform operators are compelled or obliged to respond favourably to our request. Ultimately, they make the decision. For example, *Facebook* has a content moderation location in Ghana that does for the entire African sub-region, employing 1,500 young Ghanaians doing content moderation there. Whatever they decide flouts their community standards is what holds, not what we say. We can only draw their attention to it, and they make the final decision. The final decision does not rest with the Cyber Security Authority (CSA).

Mr Speaker, thank you.

The Speaker: Prof Nyarko, I would take the last one from you.

Prof Nyarko: Mr Speaker, thank you for indulging me, and Hon Minister, I am grateful for your responses. I have seen that the Ministry's intervention has yielded in arrest. The Hon Minister has also indicated some useful programmes are being embarked upon. However, the Question was about how these interventions will curb the search. Will the Minister be kind to share with us, using historical data, whether there has been a decline in cyber security fraud in the country?

The Speaker: Yes, Hon Minister.

Mr George: Mr Speaker, the examples I gave in my substantive answer, for example, the fact that in collaboration with the Criminal Investigation Department (CID), we undertook an operation that led to the arrest of 65 suspects, which included 49 foreign nationals, clearly leads to a drop, because these are malicious actors in an active cybercrime operation who are taking out of operation and that has seen a drop. One of the very high-profile ones is the extradition case that we handled for the Economic and Organised Crime Office (EOCO), where we did surveillance and identification using the tools available to the Cyber Security Authority. Those four individuals have been extradited to the United States to face justice there.

The example of the 10 individuals who created a fake online food delivery scam and were taking money from unsuspecting

people who have been picked up, again, drops the numbers. Also, those who make phone calls to say they are from MTN, pay this money, give your SIM, we have identified and blocked 1380 of those numbers. So that definitely has led to a drop in crime. But even as we work, the criminals also improve their activities. And that is why we need to strengthen our cyber security law next year.

Mr Speaker, thank you.

The Speaker: Hon Members, we move to the next Question. That is Question number 320. It stands in the name of the Hon Member for Kintampo South, Ms Felicia Agyei. Hon Member, you may ask your Question now.

Prof Grace Ayensu-Danquah on behalf of Ms Felicia Adjei (NDC—Kintampo South): Mr Speaker Thank you, I stand on Order 88 (3), to seek your leave and that of the House, with authorisation from the Hon Member from Kintampo South, to ask the Minister for Communication, Digital Technology —

The Speaker: Have I granted you leave? You are taking it for granted. Yes, you may go on.

Prof Ayensu-Danquah: Mr Speaker, I beg to ask the Minister for Communication, Digital Technology and Innovations when the Ministry will provide access to telecommunication and internet connection in the following communities of the Kintampo South Constituency: (i) Ampoma (ii) Weila

(iii) Beabu (iv) Ayorya (v) Gazeinya (vi) Manise (vii) Dakore.

Thank you.

The Speaker: Yes, Minister.

Mr George: Mr Speaker, the Communities mentioned have not yet been captured. However, a drive test exercise will soon be arranged to capture these Communities and others in the constituency for subsequent simulation. Sites that are successful will be connected.

Mr Speaker, the communities mentioned were not captured as part of the Rural Telephony Project Phase 2. That was started by the previous administration. However, I am pleased to announce that the Ministry has done an evaluation of the work done so far. There are 461 new sites as part of the 2016 sites that are coming up. In the Kintampo South Constituency, we have shortlisted 23 communities. So, including the seven that have been mentioned here.

So Ampoma, Weila, Beabu, Ayorya, Gazeinya, Manise and Dakore and 16 more communities in the Kintampo South will be captured under the Rural Telephony Project by the end of the year.

Mr Speaker, thank you.

The Speaker: Hon Member, any supplementary questions?

Prof Ayensu-Danquah: Mr Speaker, thank you. Hon Minister, we are grateful

and I am sure that the Hon Member from Kintampo South will be very happy about this.

Thank you.

The Speaker: Hon Members, we move to — this is constituency specific so we would move on to the next Question, which is Question numbered 368. If you want to benefit, ask the substantive question, then you would benefit from it. Question 368 stands in the name of the Hon Member for Fanteakwa North, Mr Kwame Appiah Kodua, you may ask your question now.

Mr Kwame Appiah Kodua (NPP — Fanteakwa North): I beg to ask the Minister for Communication, Digital Technology and Innovation the measures instituted by the Ministry to ensure the completion of the rural telephony setup, which were ongoing in the following communities: (i) Apaa (ii) Obooho (iii) Dominase (iv) Aboorso (v) Dua-Police.

The Speaker: Hon Minister, you may answer the Question.

Mr George: i. Obooho and Dua-Police: Construction of these sites have been completed, and work is ongoing to get them integrated and operationalised.

Apaa, Dominase, and Aboorso: These sites are yet to be captured. However, a drive test exercise will soon be arranged to capture these communities and others in the Constituency for subsequent simulation and connectivity of the sites that will be successful.

The Speaker: Any supplementary questions?

Mr Kodua: Mr Speaker, thank you. For the information of the Hon Minister, there is ongoing construction at Apaa, Dominase, and then Aboorso. So, all these communities so listed or captured by the Order Paper are communities where the Ministry has started mounting telecommunication equipment over there under the previous Administration. This is for the information of the Ministry.

4:27 p.m.

The Speaker: Hon Minister, do you have any comment on what he just said? He said that in Apaa, Dominase, and Aboorso, the Ministry has already commenced work there.

There is work ongoing, even in the previous regime. That is what he is drawing your attention to.

Mr George: Very well.

Mr Speaker, we would check the status and revert to the House.

Thank you.

The Speaker: Hon Members, we move on to our next —

Mr Kodua: Mr Speaker, please, I am not done.

In respect of the two communities so mentioned by the Minister, if he may please give a timeline, because my constituency and Ghana would want to know.

Thank you so much, Mr Speaker.

The Speaker: Timeline for what?

Mr Kodua: Timelines for completion of the two communities so mentioned by the Hon Minister.

The Speaker: Yes, Minister?

Mr George: Mr Speaker, I can assure the Hon Member that work would be completed as soon as practicable.

Thank you.

The Speaker: Minister, I myself do not understand that, “as soon as practicable”. You do not have any idea as to when your Ministry can actually complete a project that has been started? I thought you have contract periods?

Mr George: Mr Speaker, the reality on the ground is that there are several factors that affect this. If it was straightforward, I am sure that the previous administration that he speaks about that started the project would have completed it. They were unable to complete it in five years. So, we are 10 months in Government, and we assure the Hon Member that he would not wait for five years like their people did under their party.

As soon as practicable, we would complete the project.

Thank you.

The Speaker: I think that you may not have the information now so you could

supply it later on. There is a contract period so you would use that contract period. If at the end of the contract period there are some challenges, and it is not completed, then people would understand. But there should be some timeline.

Mr George: Mr Speaker, this is why I am proud to call myself your son. I am guided. *[Laughter]*

The Speaker: Hon Member, I think you have one more supplementary question to ask.

Mr Kodua: Mr Speaker, I do not think I have anything to add except to thank you for your direction. I believe that the Minister is going to also follow the direction given by the Speaker.

Thank you. We are grateful.

The Speaker: Hon Members, we move on to Question number 393, it stands in the name of the Hon Member for Hemang Lower Denkyira, Mr Lawrence Agyinsam. Hon Member, you may ask your Question now.

Status of the Rural Telephony Project and Measures to Enhance Mobile Network Coverage in Hemang Lower Denkyira

Mr Lawrence Agyinsam (NPP—Hemang Lower Denkyira): Mr Speaker, I beg to ask the Minister for Communication, Digital Technology and Innovations the status of the Rural Telephony project and the plans of the Ministry for the improvement of the

mobile network service coverage in the Hemang Lower Denkyira.

The Speaker: Yes, Hon Minister?

Minister for Communication, Digital Technology and Innovations (Mr Sam Nartey George): Mr Speaker, Ankaako, Gyankobo, Nyame Bekyere, Tweapease, Ampenkrom; these sites are fully operational. In Bremang, a site has been built, integrated and work is ongoing to operationalise it. In Abrafo Odumase, construction of the sites has been completed, but it is yet to be integrated and operationalised.

A drive test is being arranged for the Hemang Lower Denkyira District to assess the Communities that are yet to be covered for consideration. Meanwhile, Ghana Investment Fund For Electronic Communications (GIFEC) is working closely with the contractor and the sub-contractors to ensure all sites are completed and operationalised by the end of 2025. But Mr Speaker, the Hon Member of Parliament has also written to my office and we have engaged with his office to complete and work in the outstanding areas in his constituency.

Thank you very much.

The Speaker: Yes, Hon Member, any supplementary?

Mr Agyinsam: Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Yes, indeed, the Minister and I have had a conversation on how to improve the Twifo Hemang Lower Denkyira

network. The reason is that Twifo Hemang Lower Denkyira District houses the Kakum Forest and it is an eyesore and quite embarrassing when visitors come from the global world to Kakum and are not able to have networks, take selfies and showcase the tourism of this country. But Minister, the Ankaako, Gyankobo and Ampenkrom that you referred to, although it has been completed and operational, there are still some challenges which I think have to do with maintenance of either the battery and other things. Coupled with that, places like Nfuom where Kakum is, places like Bremeng, Abeka Nkwanta, Tweapease, all those places, I think would require regular maintenance. Therefore, I would implore the Minister to make sure that his team continues with its monitoring.

Thank you.

The Speaker: Thank you so much, Hon Member. These are comments. We would move on to the next Question, that is Question number 607. It stands in the name of the Hon Member for Salaga North, Alhaji Alhassan Mumuni.

Hon Member, you may ask your Question.

Measures to Improve Communication Network Coverage in Bunjai–Lantinkpa and Bavim–Dagbogshe–Dasei Electoral Areas

Alhaji Alhassan Mumuni (NDC — Salaga North): Mr Speaker, I beg to ask the Minister for Communication, Digital Technology and Innovations the steps

the Ministry is implementing to improve communication network in the following electoral areas: (i) Bunjai – Lantinkpa (ii)Bavim – Dagbogshe – Dasei.

The Speaker: Yes, Minister?

Minister for Communication, Digital Technology and Innovations (Mr Sam Nartey George): Mr Speaker, these communities have not yet been captured as part of the ongoing rural Telephony Project Phase II. A drive test exercise will be arranged to capture these communities and many other communities in the constituency. The data gathered will be used for simulation, subsequent planning, and deployment for communities that pass the simulation.

Ghana Investment Fund for Electronic Communication (GIFEC) is currently working with the contractor and its sub-contractors to ensure all Sites are completed and operationalised by the end of the year.

Thank you.

The Speaker: Yes, Hon Member?

Alhaji Mumuni: Thank you very much, Mr Speaker. In the Minister's Answer, he indicated that a drive test exercise would be arranged. Would the Minister assure us of some timelines because he said they would be arranged.

The Speaker: Yes, Minister?

Mr George: Mr Speaker, guided by your earlier advice, as soon as I have better and further particulars made available to me, I would inform the Hon Member.

I thank you.

The Speaker: Hon Members, we move to the next Question.

Alhaji Mumuni: I want to use this opportunity to thank the Minister for this update. The good people of the Salaga North Constituency would be happy with the update.

Thank you very much.

The Speaker: Are you sure?
[Laughter]

You just have to follow up, get in touch with the Minister, and push him to do it as early as possible. For now, they just got an empty shell.

Can we move on to the next Question? Question number 254 stands in the name of the Hon Member for Pru West, Mr Emmanuel K. Ntekuni. Please, Hon Member, you may ask your Question now.

Mr Sanja Nanja: Mr Speaker, Mr Emmanuel Ntekuni is not there and he has asked me to ask the Question under your permission.

The Speaker: I did not hear you. He has asked you to ask the Question?

Mr Nanja: He has authorised me to ask the Question on his behalf.

The Speaker: Granted. If you have the authority— Hon Member, address the Chair.

Mr Nanja: Mr Speaker, thank you.

4:37 p.m.

Plans for the improvement of telecommunication network services in towns in the Pru West Constituency

Mr Sanja Nanja *on behalf of Mr Emmanuel Kofi Ntekuni (NDC — Pru West)*: Mr Speaker, I beg to ask the Minister for Communication, Digital Technology and Innovations the plans the Ministry has for the improvement of telecommunication network services in the following towns and communities in the Pru West constituency: (i) Adaraja Beposo (ii) Baya (iii) Senyase (iv) Fawoman (v) Kamanpa (vi) Bronikrom (vii) Cherambo and (viii) Ankrakuka.

Thank you.

Mr George: Mr Speaker, the Ghana Investment Fund for Electronic Communications (GIFEC) has built, integrated and put the following four sites on air within the Pru West Constituency: Kwaem, Krobo, Kamanpa and Fawoman.

The status of the telecommunications networks in the other communities mentioned is as follows:

Adarajo Beposo, Baya, Sanyase and Bronikrom: These communities are yet to be captured for necessary action. However, a drive test exercise is set to be arranged to capture these Sites among others in the District for simulation, subsequent planning and deployment.

Ankrakuku: This site has been surveyed and acquired for construction. Materials for the Site are ready, and construction will commence soon.

Cherambo: This Community has an existing Solar Rural Telephony Site under a Huawei-MTN Collaboration. However, the Site experiences network connectivity instability in the mornings due to weak solar batteries that have dropped to about 48 per cent capacity. The Ministry has informed MTN Ghana on the need to address the challenge.

Kamanpa: This site is fully operational. It has been built, integrated and on air, but currently facing stability issues. Field engineers of Ascend Technologies have been engaged to resolve the issue.

Fawoman: This site has been constructed, integrated and currently down due to unavailability of an electricity meter. However, GIFEC initiated the request for electricity meters which is yet to be received.

It is instructive to note that all the eight communities indicated in the request fall within the scope of the 2,016 sites targeted to be completed by the end of 2025 under the Rural Telephony and Digital Inclusion Project.

Thank you, Mr Speaker.

The Speaker: Yes, Hon Member, any supplementary?

Mr Nanja: Yes, Mr Speaker. Thank you. In respect of Cherambo, Kamanpa and Fawoman, I think that the system is there and from the answers, they are just minor problems. Could the Hon Minister give us some timelines when these minor issues can be resolved?

The Speaker: This one will be guesswork. Minor issues dealing with maintenance, guidelines as to when you can finish it, would just be some guesswork. So, it will be very difficult to give timelines on that one. Please, you may ask another supplementary question.

Mr Nanja: Mr Speaker, thank you for your guidance and I wish to thank the Hon Minister for the response. Thank you.

The Speaker: Hon Members, we move on to the last Question that is the Question numbered 319. It stands in the name of the Hon Member for Upper Manya Krobo, Mr Bismark Tetteh Nyarko. Hon Member, you may do so now.

Ms Comfort Doyoe Cudjoe: Mr Speaker, I come under Order 88(3). I seek your kind permission to ask the Question for the Hon Member for Upper Manya Krobo. I have his authority to do that.

The Speaker: All right, you may proceed.

Status of the Rural Telephony Project being undertaken in the Upper Manya Krobo Constituency

Ms Comfort Doyoe Cudjoe on behalf of Mr Bismark Tetteh Nyarko (NDC — Upper Manya Krobo): Mr Speaker, I beg to ask the Minister for Communication, Digital Technology and Innovations, the status of the Rural Telephony Project being undertaken in the Upper Manya Krobo Constituency.

Mr George: As part of the implementation of the Rural Telephony and Digital Inclusion Project, GIFEC has rolled out connectivity to seven (7) Communities in the Upper Manya Krobo District. The status of the Sites is as follows:

Bomase Hwenya: This site has been built, integrated and is on air.

Anyilesu, Anyaboni, and Aframase: These sites have been built and integrated. The process is ongoing to operationalise them.

Akohia, Kumakuma, and Akorkoma: Construction of these sites has been completed, but they are yet to be integrated and brought on air.

Mr Speaker, GIFEC has planned to conduct drive tests in some identified communities in the coming months as part of its efforts to extend connectivity to all parts of the Constituency. Thank you.

The Speaker: Hon Member, any supplementary questions?

Ms Cudjoe: Mr Speaker, no supplementary questions. We would like to thank the Hon Minister for responding to the Upper Manya Constituency. Thank you.

The Speaker: Hon Members, may I take just five minutes and come to listen to the Statements? That Statement is very important. But on your behalf, I want to discharge the Hon Minister for Communication, Digital Technology and Innovations for attending upon the House and answering the Questions.

Hon Minister, we are grateful. You are discharged.

4:47 p.m. – *Sitting suspended*

4:54 p.m. — *Sitting resumed*

[Pause]

The Speaker: Hon Members, welcome back from the five minutes suspension. We will move on to item numbered 8 on the *Order Paper*, Statements. I have a copy of the Statement and it is by the Women Caucus of Parliament on Breast Cancer Awareness: The Pink Month. So, the representative of the Caucus should go through the Statement.

STATEMENT

Breast Cancer Awareness: The Pink Month

Ms Comfort Doyoe Cudjoe (NDC — Ada): Thank you, Mr Speaker, for the opportunity.

I rise on behalf of the Women Caucus of Parliament to make this Statement as part of activities marking the global observance of Breast Cancer Awareness Month, demonstratively known as the ‘pink month’. Mr Speaker, this annual observance provides us an opportunity to draw national attention to one of the most pressing health concerns affecting women in Ghana and across the world, breast cancer.

According to the Breast Society of Ghana, breast cancer remains the leading cause of cancer-related death among women in Ghana, and the majority of cases are unfortunately diagnosed at advanced stage, when treatment becomes more complex and outcomes less favourable.

The Breast Society of Ghana, inaugurated in 2018, continues to play an instrumental role in promoting coordinated and excellent breast care in the country. The society’s message is clear and consistent: early detection saves lives. This truth, Mr Speaker, cannot be overemphasised.

Mr Speaker, the Women Caucus of Parliament join hands with the Breast Society of Ghana and all advocacy partners to intensify awareness on the need for regular breast self-examination, clinical screening and early presentation at health facilities whenever changes are noticed. Our calls go to every woman, mothers, sisters, daughters, wives, colleagues and indeed to every man to encourage and support the women in their lives to seek screening and timely care.

The Caucus also recognises that breast cancer awareness is not only a health issue, it is a social and developmental concern that demands national attention and collective responsibility. When a woman battles breast cancer, an entire family, workplace and community are affected.

Every year, the parliamentary service led by Mr Speaker organises breast cancer screening for all MPs and parliamentary staff. In this regard, the Women Caucus of Parliament pledges its full support to the National Awareness Campaign. The Caucus will continue to advocate for improved access to screening, diagnosis and treatment services across the country, with special attention to rural and underserved areas. In addition, the Caucus is committed to helping destigmatise breast cancer by addressing the myths, fear and cultural barriers that often discourage women from seeking early medical attention.

Above all, the Women Caucus will continue to champion the voices of survivors, whose experiences and testimonies remind us that there is life, hope and strength beyond breast cancer. The team adopted by the Breast Society of Ghana for this year's Awareness Campaign, *Living Beyond Breast Cancer, Together We Can*, resonates strongly with our national agenda for inclusion, compassion and resilience. Indeed, together we make a difference by promoting education, by supporting survivors and by ensuring that no woman faces breast cancer alone or in silence.

The Women Caucus is therefore calling on all stakeholders, health professionals, policymakers, development

partners, civil society and the media to join this national cause. Together, let us build a Ghana where every woman has access to early screening, quality treatment and post-care support. Allow me to use this platform to salute the dedicated health workers, advocates, volunteers and survivors who continue to inspire hope across the nation.

We also thank our development partners and all Members of Parliament who support this noble cause through awareness creation and their constituency-based initiatives. May the Almighty God bless every woman and man working towards a breast cancer-free Ghana. May He strengthen those battling the disease, comfort those who have lost loved ones and guide us all.

We continue to serve our nation with compassion, diligence and unity of purpose. Thank you, Mr Speaker, for the opportunity.

The Speaker: Hon Members, before I take your comments, let me acknowledge the presence of visitors from the Danquah International School. We have about 79 students here at the Visitor's gallery. They just arrived not long ago. And they are led by the head of the Junior High School Department, Mr Joseph Amenya. This is a school located in the Okaikwei North Constituency.

Let me, on your behalf, warmly welcome them and urge them to keep on coming. There is a lot they can learn from here so that in future when they become representatives like you, they will do better than this. Kindly resume your seats.

[Pupils of the Danquah International School were acknowledged].

The Speaker: Hon Members, you heard the Leader of the Caucus clearly and loudly. I thought that this Statement should have been made earlier. But the month is just ending, and it has been made today. Next time, let us make sure that by the first week, it is done so that we can support the efforts of the Pink Month.

In the meantime, we are ready to take a few comments. It is not only for ladies. Gentlemen, you are also permitted. Yes, Senior Member of Parliament.

Hajia Laadi Ayii Ayamba (NDC — Pusiga): Thank you very much, Mr Speaker, for the opportunity for me to add my comments to the Statement ably made by our Leader, Ms Comfort Doyoe Cudjoe.

Mr Speaker, the theme for this year is “living beyond breast cancer and together we can”. The Pink Month, which signifies a month in which we talk mostly about breast cancer, is here with us again. It is quite disheartening and disturbing that this problem is affecting many women, especially in the villages. Mr Speaker, it is very important that we pay heed to breast cancer and ensure that awareness creation goes down to the very last villages, cottages and hamlets of this country.

Mr Speaker, I am saying this because many women are not aware of what breast cancer is. Unfortunately, the breast of every woman contains some

kind of lump, and some of us mistake it, especially elderly women. To examine is one of the places where most women need to be educated. I saw my Sister, Prof Ayensu-Danquah, talking about it on television. I saw some women who also came up and were demonstrating how to detect lumps. But it is not easy. Many people do not understand. They do not even see why they should do that.

I overheard us even advising that husbands or men should help their wives to detect these lumps. Many have been laughing at this. This is not a laughing situation.

It is a very big problem; we need one another to solve the problem. Some men think that it is just for fun and wonder how to detect that. Their support is actually needed. We should not make this a talk just in the Chamber, but let us take it back to our constituencies.

5:04 p.m.

Mr Speaker, I am happy that you said this Statement is not supposed to be commented on by only women; the men here equally have wives, sisters, mothers and aunties. The awareness needs to be created so we know that there is a problem looming there, in our villages. Mr Speaker, one would see some women with some kind of prickles on their nipples. When you try to advise them, they will tell you they have been given some concoction to boil and drink every morning. Then eventually, the breast starts shrinking, becomes hard, before they realise, it is too late.

Mr Speaker, I wish to plead with the Ministry of Health to make it one of its priorities by making the nurses who travel to the villages educate and encourage the women and if possible, this should be done regularly in all our Community Health Planning and Services (CHPS) compounds, especially because these are the health facilities that we have in the villages. If we do that, it will go a long way to help us. I can assure that it is the lack of education and ignorance that causes this problem.

We are aware that when it is detected early—But how will we detect it early when we do not know that we are supposed to check ourselves? One does not even know that there is a problem. I was surprised when I heard that we can even detect it in our armpits. Mr Speaker, I was surprised. I have never tried looking for any lump in my armpit because I have never thought breast cancer could be something that would be a lump in my armpit. If, at my level, I am hearing this for the first time, what about a villager in Pusiga who has never even thought that there is anything called breast cancer?

So, Mr Speaker, for your interest and support for women, I wish to plead that you help us ensure that every MP in this House takes up an activity. Even if they have already done it, extend it, ensure our local radio stations continue to sing the anthem of the need for women to check their breasts for lumps, and any suspicion should be reported.

Mr Speaker, because there is not much time, I wish to say a very big thank you for giving us this opportunity, although

we are all yearning to go, and to thank my Colleague women and all other MPs for listening to me.

The Speaker: Hon Members, may you guide me as to the time allotment per Member, because I see that a lot of Members want to comment. Sorry? How many minutes per person?

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, we do three minutes.

The Speaker: Three minutes. So, we will start with Dr Anaba.

Dr Thomas Winsum Anaba (NDC — Garu): Mr Speaker, thank you very much, for the opportunity to contribute to this presentation by our Leader on Breast Cancer Awareness Month.

Let me first of all commend you for your involvement in this Breast Cancer Awareness Month by allowing Parliament to use the premises to advocate on breast cancer awareness, and also thank the Women Caucus for the good job done. Just to add that next time, I would encourage them to do it outside Accra, possibly in Garu, to bring more awareness to the people there, because they do not have a medium of communication like we have here to listen to the radio and the rest. So going there would actually shed more light on it.

What I want to add, Mr Speaker, is that we are talking about giving a full month to create awareness about the first restaurant of everybody on earth; that is where we all go to eat our first food when

we are born. So it is very important that we dedicate time to speaking about it. One thing is that people believe that breast cancer is only for women. Let me advise our men here that we have one to two per cent of men in the world who can develop breast cancer. So they should not only be looking at checking or educating their wives, but also check themselves because delay in diagnosing it, as they said, would cause irreversible damage to the breast, and they may lose their lives because of that.

Lack of awareness is something that would also cause one to develop the sickness and poor treatment. But the good news is that with the MahamaCares coming, some of these cancers are going to be managed properly, and with this awareness we are creating, people will get to check themselves, go for their mammograms when they are placed in all the regional hospitals for early diagnosis and go for the right treatment to curb mortalities. We are told that about 450 women die yearly in Ghana as a result of breast cancer because of a lack of diagnosis and a lack of awareness. Thanks to God, MahamaCares is coming. Definitely with that, we would be able to diagnose and treat them early.

What we need to do is to give more resources to our public and community health nurses, train them on how to diagnose them early and also get them portable ultrasounds from the MahamaCares to ensure that they are able to scan the breast and the armpits. That way, the chemotherapy, radiotherapy and the surgery will reduce the mortalities to zero.

To this end, I would say, thank you for the opportunity to contribute to this important, thematic area, talking about the first restaurant of everybody on earth.
— *[Hear! Hear!]* —

The Speaker: Yes, Hon Member?

Dr Fred Kyei Asamoah (NPP — Offinso North): Mr Speaker, we would like to appreciate the maker of the Statement on behalf of the Women's Caucus as we create more awareness on breast cancer. I would also like to appreciate you, Mr Speaker, and the Parliamentary Service.

The entire month, I have seen that the staff here have been wearing pink dresses throughout and a lot of activities to create more awareness. As we say, prevention is always better than cure. With breast cancer, as with any other type of cancer, it can lead to death. And one will want to prevent it as much as possible before one gets into treatment.

So, Mr Speaker, in other jurisdictions, they tend to make it compulsory as part of their primary health care to ensure that all women from the age of 40 go for a check-up, I mean a mammogram. Sometimes, it is expensive, so in our part of the world, it might be very difficult to afford. But normal physical examination by the woman herself or men, helping their wives to check and to examine their breasts for any kind of unusual physical appearance or lumps, is something that we want to encourage.

Like one of our Members said, the breast is something that has fed almost

everybody in the world, and all of us are alive because of a woman. We want to keep them alive long enough to be able to continue to bless us.

Mr Speaker, I would like us not only to create awareness for just one month of the year but to ensure that we put in some activities that will be done year-round, because when one gets breast cancer and is even treated, sometimes there are relapses that could lead to other kinds of cancers as well. We want to encourage ourselves, especially as representatives of the people, to put in programmes within our various constituencies and organisations, to make sure that we take the country along to ensure that we prevent it as much as possible. When we do not prevent it, and it gets into treatment, it becomes more expensive. If we can commit more funds into prevention, it is something that will help us as a country. Thank you.

5:14 p.m.

The Speaker: Thank you, Hon Member. Can we listen to a lady? Yes?

Ms Lydia Lamisi Akanvariba (NDC — Tempene): Thank you very much, Mr Speaker, for the opportunity to contribute to this all-important Statement made by our able Leader. I think we have spoken so much about this, but there is one aspect that we need to look at critically. Most of the people get to a stage where surgery and other treatments become difficult because of superstition and local treatments. That is why we need to emphasise the awareness of breast cancer. For example, I met a

certain woman who had breast cancer. It started as a lump; just a small lump on her breast.

When she went back home, after the doctor had said they had wanted to excise it, they told her no, and that if it is removed, she would die. Eventually, the woman died. It is because of the superstition that when you have a boil, or when you have something like a boil in your body, and you go to the hospital, they inject you, or give you some kind of treatment, you are likely to die. But at the end of the day, if you do not treat it, you will die anyway. We need to let that awareness be on our lips all the time. If we are only using one month of the whole year, what about the rest of the 11 months that are remaining? We need to continue this education.

Again, local treatment, sometimes they will say just go for the local treatment and when they put some herbs on it, it will cure by itself. However, cancer has nothing to do with local treatment. You put all the herbs on it, and it will continue to grow. At the end of the day, it will kill you. So, why do we not make sure that the awareness or the education goes down, that when a person has a lump, it is better they remove it than for them to use local treatment.

Let us also emphasise the fact that the men have to help us. Men and husbands, please kindly help us. It is something that you are with a woman for the rest of your life. It is better you help her to examine her breast every month, so that it will help you the man detect it early so that she will survive for you; otherwise, she

will end up dying, and you do not have a wife, or your children do not have a mother. Please, let men do their bit by helping our women to examine the breast, notice any lump in the breast, and then at the end of the day, they will be able to support their mothers and sisters to get early detection and early treatment. Probably, early support will help us to live longer. Thank you very much. I am most grateful.

The Speaker: Yes, Hon Member?

Prof Titus Beyuo: Mr Speaker, thank you for the opportunity to contribute to the Statement, and let me thank the Women Caucus for taking this up. I want to put on record that data suggests that breast cancers in Ghana occur at a relatively younger age compared to the rest of the world, and they are also more aggressive than other parts of the world.

This means that we have to ensure that we do early diagnosis to minimise the risk associated with it. In this light, I want to call on the Ministry of Health to ensure equitable distribution of mammograms equipment across the country. Mammography services are not available from Kumasi and beyond. We can find them in Accra and Kumasi. From Techiman and beyond, we will not get one in the public hospitals, which means that women in the upper regions of this country do not have access to screening, and so we need to ensure equitable distribution.

I also want to commend the Ministry of Health and its partners, especially the corporate world, and I want to make

particular mention of Pfizer. There is a particular medication that is so helpful to women with breast cancer, called Palbociclib. This is a targeted treatment, and with the collaboration of the Ministry, they have reduced the price of this drug from about GHC36,000 per month to GHC2,000. It has a very helpful medication. We commend them and ask the National Health Insurance Authority to see if with this reduction, they can incorporate this into their benefit package, so that a lot of women can benefit from this medication.

Finally, I would want to encourage that we reduce stigma, especially against women who have had mastectomy. It is the reason a lot of women resist mastectomy, that is surgery to remove their breast, even when it is life-saving. I will call on men to render support to our mothers, wives, and sisters, if they need to undergo such urgent procedures.

In conclusion, Mr Speaker, the free primary health care brings a lot of hope, and when this policy is launched, we should all latch onto it, because it will promote screening by community health workers at their homes, in the lorry stations; we will have clinics at all these places. It is not for sick people. Anybody can walk in and be screened for non-communicable diseases, including cancers, and breast cancer is certainly one of them. So it is one of the life-saving policies that H.E. John Dramani Mahama intends to implement. When it is implemented, it will improve our disease burden for non-communicable diseases. Thank you very much for the opportunity to contribute.

The Speaker: Yes, Hon Member?

Mr Matthew Nyindam (NPP — Kpandai): Thank you, Mr Speaker, for the opportunity to contribute to the Statement ably made by the Women Caucus of this House. The effect of breast cancer cannot be overestimated. If you are a Member of Parliament, and you really tour your constituency all the time, you will get to know that we have lost or we are losing precious women because of breast cancer. The early detection and education in most of our rural communities is lacking. Women really do not want to accept that some kind of pain that they feel might result in breast cancer. The idea is, “no, I need some local treatments”, just like one of our Colleagues said. You could encounter a woman who will not even want to appreciate the advice you are giving her to go to the hospital. Sometimes, Mr Speaker, it is so bad that they do not even want to open it for people to see. They end up losing their lives.

5:24 p.m.

Mr Speaker, I want to ask the Women Caucus to do more work, not just make a Statement. We need to educate our women. They need to come together as a Women Caucus. Tour constituencies, let people appreciate, and educate them that this is breast cancer.

I agree with the fact that it is mostly about women, and they always call on us to assist them. But, Mr Speaker, there is a debate out there: who is even the rightful owner of the breast? Mr Speaker, the debate is out there, whether it is the

woman, the child or the man. This debate, Mr Speaker, if you look at the Majority Side, the men are debating. It is our responsibility to make sure that we protect the breast.

Even when we are weaned off — Mr Speaker we will get back there again— *[Laughter]*—So the women should not call on us to assist them. It is our responsibility to make sure that the breast is free of breast cancer. Mr Speaker, on a more serious note, let us engage our community health nurses. They are very close to the women and to the community. Early education and detection will help us, to some extent, prevent this breast cancer. On this note, Mr Speaker, I want to thank you for the opportunity.

The Speaker: The Hon Member behind the Hon lady. Yes, please, you may make your comments.

Ms Rachel Amma Owusuah (NDC — Dormaa East): Thank you, Mr Speaker. It is said that cancer or breast cancer cannot be prevented because the main cause is unknown. However, when it is detected early, it can be treated than when reported to the hospital at a later stage where the prognosis becomes unfavourable. So, to add my voice to what my Hon Senior Colleagues have already stated, I suggest and appeal to all midwives and the community health nurses to palpate every pregnant woman during antenatal clinic visits. Also, when a woman goes into the labour ward, they do head-to-toe examination during such conditions, and after delivery, they also go to the postnatal clinic. That one also

can be done to detect the condition earlier for treatment.

And to our husbands and boyfriends, the sucking of the breast should not be the only interest during the process of love making. I appeal to them also to touch the breast, feel and palpate for any abnormalities. So that in case of any abnormalities, they can detect it early and the woman could go for treatment, and this can help save lives and prevent the condition from getting worse. Thank you, Mr Speaker for the opportunity. *[Hear! Hear!]*

The Speaker: Yes, please?

Ms Shirley Kyei (NPP — Atwima Nwabiagya South): Thank you, Mr Speaker for the opportunity to comment on the Statement ably made by the leader of the Women's Caucus.

Mr Speaker, breast cancer is something that we are all at risk of as women. As I learned today, well, I have known in the past, but more light was thrown on it, that men too are at risk of breast cancer. With all of us being susceptible to this, I would say that there is the need for us to get educated.

Mr Speaker, no one gets up and anticipates getting breast cancer. For our women out there, that have gone through this, it is my prayer that we all lend them the support that they need because there is a lot of stigmata associated with this and it makes them coil into their shells and unable to socialise or share their stories. I also know that there are a lot of support groups or resources out there and

these support groups are there for us to be able to talk to. So, for our women, we should be able to get out there and get the needed support that we need.

We know that symptoms and causes of breast cancer varies. We have talked about swelling in the armpits, thickening of the breast and all that. I pray that as women, we look out for these things. We should be able to check ourselves. It is not just about going to the hospital to get checked out. We should be able to do our normal checks in the house. We have also asked and implored our men to help us in these checks. So, our men, like Hon Member who contributed to the Statement said, this is their first restaurant and is imperative that they make sure that their first restaurant is in order.

I would also like to say that as a country, we should commit more resources to research to be able to know the real causes of breast cancer. I know with your able leadership and with the Ghana Medical Trust Fund, "MahamaCares" we would dedicate more funds to finding out the real causes of breast cancer and giving a prolonged lifespan to our women and our mothers out there. Thank you very much Mr Speaker for the opportunity.

The Speaker: Yes, that would be the last comment.

Dr Mahama: Thank you very much Mr Speaker. I want to also commend the Women's Caucus of this Parliament for the initiative during this month, "the Pink October month", and to your good

self for supporting the various activities marking the month.

Mr Speaker, the breast is an endangered species. It is such an endangered valuable resource that the rate at which it is depleted with needless loss of lives due to breast cancer is something that should alarm the conscience of this country. Various contributors to that particular Statement have highlighted the scientific, social and economic imperative of the need for us to tackle head-on, this menace of breast cancer.

I think that just like the Hon Member for Kpandai stated, the importance of the breast cannot be overemphasised. It is an established fact that women are only the host of the breast. The utility of the breast serves third parties and people outside the host of this breast. *[Laughter]*

Mr Speaker, the first major beneficiary of this valuable resource is the child. The child grows and if it happens to be a male child, like Hon Jerry Ahmed Shaib, there is a lifelong growth to benefit from the breast again. So, the fight, advocacy and conscious support for the women and men in fighting breast cancer should be of collective interest to all of us.

But I also want to note, with an uneasy heart, the reticence of men in supporting women in the fight against breast cancer. Mr Speaker, why do I say the reticence? I think that as a principle and maybe law, we should consider an implied duty on every married man, to ensure, as part of the duty to the necessity of life, they send their wives for screening at least once

every year or once every six months. This conscious effort by way of an implied duty imposed on every married man would help us reduce the reluctance of many women not wanting to be screened. Mr Speaker, once this is done, and while we are even looking at other Bills, — I read that in this particular House, they are trying to bring the Spousal Property Bill. We should also be reflecting how we can impose, in all the Bills that are coming, a duty on the man to ensure that his wife, who is under his care, is regularly screened.

5:34 p.m.

My Colleague, Prof Beyuo also mentioned the issue of Government coming in to support this initiative.

Mr Speaker, the absence of mammography or any of such x-ray equipment for the purpose of screening or checking the breast is something that should not be allowed in the 21st century. For a country that is over 60 years old, we can only get the facilities and accessories for assessing or examining the breast in Accra or in the southern part of the country. I know the leadership of Parliament and the Rt Hon Speaker will not let the issue as raised by my Colleague go to sleep.

The Minister for Finance would bring the Budget and we have the responsibility of approving the Budget. Let us find out in the Budget whether the Minister for Finance has made adequate provisions at least for every regional capital to have mammography services being rendered for the people of Ghana,

so that every corner of the country at least will be safe from the needless loss of lives.

Mr Speaker, as a young boy, I grew up also learning about a popular advocacy which I did not hear much of this year. It is “Free the Apples”. I do not know whether it is still associated with breast cancer awareness. The women also have the responsibility not to imprison the breast. They have the responsibility to be conscious that imprisoning the breast is also a risk factor—*[Interruption]*—Imprisoning the breast means wearing brassieres so tight that there is even no space for the breast to breathe—*[Laughter]*—It is a risk factor. I think that—I am not a witchdoctor—*[Laughter]*—

Mr Speaker, with these few words, I want to commend the Leader of the Caucus for this brilliant Statement and to say that the Rt Hon Speaker should check the Budget, whether there are adequate provisions made for this issue as part of his legacies for this particular House.

Thank you very much, Mr Speaker.

The Speaker: Hon Members, let me—Sorry, I thought we were concluding. I just wanted to thank Members for taking this matter seriously. This is a serious malady confronting our nation and from the information we gathered from the experts, there is some peculiarity with our situation in Africa and particularly in Ghana. I am happy that you have all taken this seriously.

To demonstrate our support to the national course of cancer awareness, I direct that the Clerk’s office deducts

GH¢1,000.00 from each Member’s salary for the month of November, to be dedicated to the fight we are all engaged in in the Cancer Awareness Month and that money be given to the Breast Society of Ghana—*[Hear! Hear!]*—That would amount to GH¢276,000.00 I would provide the remaining to round it up to GH¢300,000.00—*[Hear! Hear!]*—Which will donate to the Breast Society of Ghana, to assist them in the work they are doing.

This is a very important matter. I have seen and witnessed how devastating breast cancer is to our women and I think that if we had had some of these Statements earlier, we could have done more. But please, let us all invest in it. It is not just health, but it is social and economic and I think that it will help all of us. So, just GH¢1,000.00 would be deducted per Member and that will amount to GH¢276,000.00. I would top up with GH¢24,000.00 to make it GH¢300,000.00 for the Breast Society of Ghana.

I believe that, early December, the Breast Society of Ghana will call on the Parliament of Ghana to pick up GH¢300,000.00 as our collective contribution to support the work you are doing. We want to take this opportunity to thank you so much and to encourage many more men and women to support this. As for the ownership, it is a gift that God has given to humanity. So, we all own it and enjoy it. So, please, let us all invest in this precious life. But the women, I beg you to teach the men sometimes how to examine and suck it — *[Laughter]* — Because it is very important and that is why I said they

should teach you, because the men are too knowing —Which other way? — *[Laughter]* — Take your time and teach them, because not all of them are used to it. Some of those coming from rural areas shy away from it; they do not even understand it. You, see?

Mr Jerry Ahmed Shaib: They are not allowed.

The Speaker: They are not allowed in the rural areas? When we were kids, it was free. It was not hidden. To use somebody's words, it was not imprisoned. It was available for us to see. But these days, you people capture and imprison your breasts. Also, there is this charge that is always lurking around. You can be charged with sexual harassment and that makes it more difficult for the men. So please, women, also be inviting—You know. I did not say be offering it, but I say be inviting, so they can help you.

With this, I want to, on your behalf, call it a day, unless the Leaders have something to say.

Majority Chief Whip (Mr Rockson-Nelson Etse Kwami Dafeamekpor): Mr Speaker, we agree with you that within the terms of Standing Order 55(3), not having sat for five hours, we adjourn the House.

We want to encourage Members that next week, Business will be quite heavy, so Committee Leaders should endeavour to slate Committee work in the mornings, so that by 1.45 p.m. we would be ready and have adequate numbers to deal with serious Business in the

afternoon. This is my plea to Members, especially Committee Leaders to slate Committee work for the mornings.

Mr Speaker, I thank you for the opportunity.

Mr Shaib — *rose* —

The Speaker: Second Deputy Minority Whip?

Second Deputy Minority Whip (Mr Jerry Ahmed Shaib): Mr Speaker, we are not opposed to the application— *[Interruption]*—It is a Motion that it should be adjourned—Yes, Speaker.

The Speaker: Sorry?

Mr Shaib: Mr Speaker, he asked that the House be adjourned to Tuesday at 2 o'clock, and I said we are not opposed to that.

The Speaker: Hon Members, I proceed to adjourn the House to Tuesday at 2 o'clock in the afternoon, and I wish all of you an enjoyable weekend. Please take the last days to make sure that you participate in the Breast Cancer Awareness Month.

With this, the House is accordingly adjourned.

Thank you.

ADJOURNMENT

The House was adjourned at 5:46 p.m. till Tuesday, 4th November, 2025 at 2:00 p.m.

